Activity 3 Guide - Control Exposure and Colour at a Corporate Event

Scenario: An event organiser needs speaker and audience photographs under mixed warm stage light and cool ambient light.

Tools: Smartphone with Pro/Manual mode or exposure compensation, optional monopod

Deliverable: Exposure/focus test set, white-balance comparison and five usable event frames

Detailed step-by-step

1. Identify the priority subject and the brightest important highlight in the scene.
2. Clean the lens, silence flash and choose a stable, permitted camera position.
3. Tap the speaker's face to focus and lower exposure until facial highlights retain detail.
4. Lock AE/AF for a consistent burst when distance and light remain unchanged.
5. Capture a short burst at a gesture or interaction, then select the sharpest frame.
6. Compare auto, warm and cool white-balance settings on the same scene.
7. Choose the setting that keeps skin credible while preserving the intended atmosphere.
8. Capture a wide establishing view, two medium interactions and two close reactions.
9. Check motion blur, focus, colour shifts, clipped screens and distracting badges.
10. Record the chosen focus, exposure and white-balance decisions in the evidence log.

Acceptance criteria

[ ] Faces are sharp and readable

[ ] Important highlights are not clipped

[ ] White balance is consistent across the sequence

[ ] Five frames cover place, action and reaction

Troubleshooting

- Missing control: use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- Soft result: clean, stabilise, re-focus and repeat.
- Clipped highlight: lower exposure or change the light/camera position.
- Unsafe/unauthorised capture: stop and use a controlled substitute.